

Tony Di Fabbio, Dr.-Ing.

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🌐 Tony Di Fabbio



Experiences

- 05/2026 – ongoing

MSCA Global Postdoctoral Fellow (LINERFUN project) – Politecnico di Torino (beneficiary), University of Melbourne (outgoing host), ONERA (secondment, Aug–Dec 2026)

Research on advanced acoustic liner technologies for Ultra-High Bypass Ratio engines, combining high-fidelity CFD/CAA, time-domain impedance boundary conditions, and physics-informed machine learning to design compact, low-drag, noise-reducing liners for aero-engines and future urban air mobility applications.
- 08/2026 – 12/2026

Visiting Researcher (LINERFUN secondment) at ONERA – The French Aerospace Lab, Toulouse

Five-month secondment in the Branch B2A team led by Dr. Estelle Piot. Experimental characterisation of acoustic liners and validation of physics-improved time-domain impedance boundary conditions against grazing-flow wind-tunnel data.
- 10/2024 – 04/2026

Postdoctoral Research Fellow at Leonardo Innovation Labs, Digital Twin and Advanced Simulation

Development of digital twin technologies for aerospace systems using high-fidelity CFD. Focus on aeroacoustics and high-speed compressible flows (supersonic/hypersonic), with applications to multiphysics simulations that support Multi-Disciplinary Design Optimization frameworks.
- 03/2024 – 06/2024

Scientific Researcher at The University of Melbourne

DAAD scholarship holder

Application of Machine Learning techniques—specifically Gene Expression Programming for Multi-Objective Optimization of complex engineering systems. Research focused on enhancing CFD-driven design processes through genetic algorithm modeling.
- 02/2020 – 02/2024

Scientific Researcher at Universität der Bundeswehr München

Numerical and theoretical research in aerodynamics and turbulence modeling. Activities included simulation and analysis of transonic cavity flows, leading-edge vortex dynamics, unsteady shock–vortex interactions, and control strategies for separated flows, with applications relevant to aerospace vehicle design and flow control.
- 10/2022 – 12/2022

Visiting Researcher at The University of Melbourne

Investigation of hybrid CFD–Machine Learning approaches for flowfield prediction and model acceleration. Focus on data-driven strategies for enhancing computational efficiency in fluid dynamics simulations.
- 04/2019 – 11/2019

Junior Scientific Researcher at DLR Lampoldshausen

Conducted high-fidelity simulations of a sub-scale LOX/CH₄ rocket combustor. Studied combustion stability and thermal characteristics to support experimental validation and propulsion system design.
- 02/2018 – 07/2018

Teaching Assistant at Politecnico di Torino

Assisted in lectures and practical sessions for the “Mechanical Machines” course. Supported students in understanding machine dynamics, thermodynamic cycles, and performance analysis.

Experiences (continued)

- 10/2017 – 09/2018  **Delegate and Student Representative** at Collegio Einaudi, Torino
Acted as liaison between students and administrative board. Promoted academic initiatives and coordinated student engagement programs.
- 10/2017 – 07/2018  **Student Team Member** of Polito Sailing Team Torino
Contributed to designing and constructing a high-performance sailboat for the “MILLE E UNA VELA CUP 2017.” Involved in hull optimization, structural layout, and system integration.

Education

- 02/2020 – 08/2024  **PhD** at the Universität der Bundeswehr München
Final grade: Summa cum Laude
Thesis title: *Efficient Turbulence Modelling for Vortical Flows from Swept Leading Edges*
- 09/2018 – 09/2019  **Technische Universität München** Master Student
Erasmus+ programme exchange
- 09/2017 – 12/2019  **M.Sc. Politecnico di Torino** in Aerospace Engineering
Final grade: 110 cum laude/110
Thesis title: *Numerical simulation of a sub-scale rocket combustor, carried out in the framework of CNES-DLR cooperation*
- 02/2017 – 06/2017  **École Centrale Paris** Bachelor Student
EU/Young Talents program with scholarship by Politecnico di Torino
- 09/2014 – 07/2017  **B.Sc. Politecnico di Torino** in Aerospace Engineering
Final grade: 110 cum laude/110
Member of the Polito Young Talent Project: educational path of excellence for the top 200 undergraduate students in each academic year
- 09/2015 – 07/2018  **Student at Collegio Universitario di Torino “R. Einaudi”**
The College “R. Einaudi” is legally recognized by the Italian Ministry of Education as “High cultural qualification Institution”
- 09/2009 – 07/2014  **Liceo scientifico “A.Romita” Campobasso**
Second level college of science with final grade 100/100

Skills

- Languages  Mother tongue in Italian
Strong reading, writing, and speaking competencies in English (C1)
Good reading, writing, and speaking competencies in French, German (B1)
- Coding  Python, C, C++, Matlab, $\LaTeX$
- Software  DLR-TAU code, OpenFoam, Ennova, Ansys Fluent, Comsol, Solidworks, Office
- Field of Research  Delta-wing aerodynamics for high-agile military aircraft
Applied CFD and turbulence modeling for aerodynamic applications
Evolutionary Algorithms and Gene Expression Programming
- Misc  Academic research, teaching, training, consultation
Expertise in writing research proposals (MSCA 2024 Global Post-Doctoral Fellowship Seal of Excellence)
- Social  Dynamic attitude inclined to approach problems and requests analytically and methodically to provide a solution soon. Strong orientation to teamwork and a sense of responsibility toward the aim. Optimistic and future-oriented.

Prizes, Awards and Funding Received

- POLITO Young Talent Project Member
- DGLR Young Talent Award (German Society for Aeronautics and Astronautics): €3,000
- EDISU University Scholarship: €25,000 (5 years, €5,000/year)
- Collegio Einaudi Merit Scholarships (3 awards): €1,000 each
- ERASMUS+ and POLITO Scholarship for TUM exchange: €6,000
- POLITO Young Talent Project Scholarship for École Centrale Paris exchange: €4,200
- Doctoral Fellowship from Airbus Defence and Space, Manching, Germany: €344,240.40
- DAAD Doctoral Fellowship for Research Abroad: €7,050
- LRZ SuperMUC-NG grants (2 awards): 60 million CPU hours (approx. €1,200,000 equivalent)
- MSCA Global Fellowship (awarded 2025; project start: May 2026), total funding: €309,153.72

Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles

- D. Kotzłowski, T. Di Fabbio, E. Tangermann, M. Klein, Y. Fang, and R. D. Sandberg, “Enhancing One-Equation Turbulence Models for Delta Wings by Gene Expression Programming,” *ALAA Journal*, vol. 64, no. 4, pp. 2189–2205, 2026.
Contribution: Designed symbolic GEP corrections introducing nonlinear stress–strain terms and a revised turbulence production term; trained on a single delta wing and validated on double and triple delta configurations, enabling an interpretable and robust modelling workflow.
- T. Di Fabbio, E. Tangermann, M. Klein, Y. Fang, and R. D. Sandberg, “Strategies for Enhancing One-Equation Turbulence Model Predictions Using Gene-Expression Programming,” *Fluids*, 2024, 9(8).
Contribution: Developed two GEP pathways extending the Boussinesq assumption and constructing a new one-equation closure using solver-in-the-loop training for deployable wall-bounded turbulence models.
- K. Rajkumar, T. Di Fabbio, E. Tangermann, and M. Klein, “Physical aspects of vortex–shock dynamics in delta wing configurations,” *Physics of Fluids*, 2024.
Contribution: Quantified shock–vortex interaction mechanisms across double and triple delta planforms through CFD and enstrophy transport analysis, identifying geometry- and incidence-driven buffet sensitivity.
- T. Di Fabbio, K. Rajkumar, E. Tangermann, and M. Klein, “Towards the understanding of vortex breakdown for improved RANS turbulence modelling,” *Aerospace Science and Technology*, 2024.
Contribution: Diagnosed physical and modelling causes of one-equation RANS failures in transonic sideslip and proposed a validated modification improving stability and accuracy.
- T. Di Fabbio, E. Tangermann, and M. Klein, “Analysis of the vortex-dominated flow field over a delta wing at transonic speed,” *The Aeronautical Journal*, 2023.
Contribution: Produced high-fidelity datasets resolving vortex systems and shocks; analysed eddy viscosity and Reynolds stresses in vortex formation and maintenance.
- T. Di Fabbio, E. Tangermann, and M. Klein, “Investigation of transonic aerodynamics on a triple-delta wing in sideslip conditions,” *CEAS Aeronautical Journal*, 2022.
Contribution: Demonstrated RANS limitations and advantages of high-fidelity approaches for predicting vortex and shock interactions, improving aerodynamic load predictions.

Conference Presentations and Proceedings

- G. A. Bres, C. B. Ivey, L. Heidt, K. Wang, S. T. Bose, R. Hottois, J. Guerrero, and T. Di Fabbio, “GPU-Accelerated Large-Eddy Simulations of High-Speed Cavity Flows With Dynamic Doors Deployment,” 32nd AIAA/CEAS Aeroacoustics Conference, 2026, pp. 3359.
- E. Segalerba, T. Di Fabbio, V. Rossano, and J. Guerrero, “Towards a generalized open-source turbulence model for external aerodynamics,” 20th OpenFOAM Workshop (OFW20), Vienna, Austria, 2025.
- V. Rossano, T. Di Fabbio, E. Segalerba, and J. Guerrero, “Verification and Validation of OpenFOAM for High-Speed Aerodynamics,” 20th OpenFOAM Workshop (OFW20), Vienna, Austria, 2025.
- G. Zampa, T. Di Fabbio, E. Segalerba, and J. Guerrero, “Optimization of Hypersonic Re-Entry Vehicle Aerodynamics for Communication Blackout Mitigation,” European Microwave Week, Utrecht, The Netherlands, 2025.
- T. Di Fabbio, E. Segalerba, E. Tangermann, and M. Klein, “Towards a machine learning-augmented one-equation turbulence model for external aerodynamics in an open-source framework,” DGLR Conference, Augsburg, Germany, 2025 (forthcoming).
- T. Di Fabbio, E. Tangermann, and M. Klein, “Flow pattern analysis on a delta wing at transonic speed,” AIAA SciTech Forum, San Diego, CA, 2022.
- T. Di Fabbio, E. Tangermann, and M. Klein, “Investigation of leading-edge vortices on a triple-delta-wing configuration using scale-adaptive simulation,” ICAS Congress, Stockholm, Sweden, 2022.
- T. Di Fabbio, E. Tangermann, and M. Klein, “Investigation of Reynolds stresses prior to vortex breakdown on a triple-delta wing at transonic condition,” 12th International Symposium on Turbulence and Shear Flow Phenomena (TSFP12), Osaka, Japan, 2022.
- T. Di Fabbio, E. Tangermann, M. Klein, S. Ketterl, and A. Winkler, “Comparative scale-resolving and RANS simulations of a delta wing configuration,” DGLR Conference, Bonn, Germany, 2020.